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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

2026–Present	**Associate Professor**, Department of Human Development and Family Science, College of Arts and Sciences, Syracuse University
2026–Present	**Zeta Psi Endowed Faculty Fellow**, Syracuse University
2021–2026	**Assistant Professor**, Department of Human Development and Family Science, Syracuse University
2019–2021	**Assistant Professor**, Department of Human Development and Family Sciences, Texas Tech University
2018–2019	**Postdoctoral Fellow**, Department of Health Management and Informatics, University of Central Florida, Orlando, Florida
2017–2018	**Postdoctoral Fellow**, Department of Psychology, University of Victoria, British Columbia, Canada

EDUCATION

2017	**Ph.D., Educational Psychology**, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign. College of Education, Department of Educational Psychology, Division of Child Development Dissertation: *Examining the reciprocal associations between delinquency and parental monitoring in two adolescent samples: A within- and between-person latent variable analysis* [Order No. 10832091]. http://hdl.handle.net/2142/97557
2010	**Ed.M., Human Resource Development**, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign. College of Education, Department of Human Resource Education
2009	**B.A., Sociology**, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign. College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, Department of Sociology

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Prevention science and school-based program evaluation; Healthy adolescent development in the transition to young adulthood; Identity-based harassment, bullying, and psychosocial outcomes; Adolescent risk, resilience, and developmental trajectories; Longitudinal quantitative methods and R programming.

GRANTS AND FUNDED RESEARCH

2026–2028 **Co-I**. Co-developing a measure of digital mental health help-seeking with and for Black adolescents, William T. Grant Foundation, $304,677 (Funding Period: 6/1/2026 - 5/31/2028 - Funded) (Grant Number: 205724).

2026–2031 **Collaborator**. Recovery from nonsuicidal self-injury in early adulthood: Testing facilitators and barriers of change in an accelerated longitudinal design, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada, Insight Grant, $340,416 (Funding Period: 4/1/2026 – 3/31/2031 - Funded) (Grant Number: 435-2026-0550).

2021–2024 **Co-I**. Root causes of bias-based harassment in schools: Risk and protective factors across multiple levels of the social ecology. National Institute of Justice, $1,290,546 (Funding Period: 1/1/2021 – 12/30/2024 - Funded) (Grant Number: NIJ-2020-CK-BX-0005).

2016–2020 **Co-I**. The Impact of Sources of Strength, a primary prevention youth suicide program, on sexual violence perpetration among Colorado high school students, National Center for Injury Prevention and Control, Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (U01), $1,800,000 (Funding Period: 9/30/2016 – 9/29/2020 - Funded) (Grant Number: 1U01CE002841-01).

2018–2019 **PI**. The relations among polysubstance use, treatment utilization, and health service outcomes, Fulbright Canada (Funding Period: 1/1/2018 – 1/1/2019 - Recommended to be funded).

2018–2019 **Co-I**. Trajectories of marijuana use across a decade: Their predictors in adolescence and impact on health, academic, social, and economic outcomes in young adulthood, Canadian Institutes of Health Research, $100,000 (Funding Period: 1/2018 – 8/2019 - Funded) (Grant Number: SHI-155410).

PUBLICATIONS

Note. * = mentored student-led manuscript.

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles (n = 84)

Merrin, G. J., Nickodem, K., Grant, N., Weerakoon, S. M., Holt, M. K., & Espelage, D. L. (2026). CATAcode: A principled approach for coding check-all-that-apply demographic items. *Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science, 8*(4). https://doi.org/10.1177/25152459251401184

*Liu, Q., **Merrin, G. J.**, Razza, R. A., & Vasilenko, S. A. (2026). Transient Fluctuation and Persistent Exposure of Material Hardship: Implications for Behavioral Self-Regulation in Childhood. *Family Relations*. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1111/fare.70340

Arora, I. S., **Merrin, G. J.**, April, K., April-Sanders, A. K., Lawrence, T., Grant, N., & Gordon, D. M. (2026). Unseen in the system: Longitudinal pathways and latent transitions from caregiver intimate partner violence exposure to mental health and substance use outcomes among child welfare system-involved youth. *International Journal of Mental Health and Addiction*. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11469-026-01708-1

Zhang, C., Vasilenko, S., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2026). State Policies, School Counselors, and Mental Health Disparities Among LGBQ+ Youth. *JAMA Network Open*. https://doi.org/10.1001/jamanetworkopen.2026.50065

*Jian, B., *Wusirige, & **Merrin, G. J.** (2026). Identity-linked peer stress and internalizing distress: Heterogeneous joint trajectories across two years in adolescence. *Development and Psychopathology*.

*Wusirige, *Jian, B., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2026). Longitudinal associations between authoritarian parenting and adolescent antisocial thinking, depression, and anxiety: Between- and within-person effects. *Journal of Research on Adolescence, 36*(3), Article e70259. https://doi.org/10.1111/jora.70259

*Huang, Y., Zaff, J. F., **Merrin, G. J.**, Green, J. G., & Medina, M. A. (2026). Development of the Academic Stress Scale for Adolescents and examination of perceived academic stress among Chinese adolescents. *Psychology in the Schools, 63*(5), 924–939. https://doi.org/10.1002/pits.70136

*Davis, K., Razza, R., Brann, L., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2026). Integrating mindful feeding into responsive feeding guidance. *Maternal & Child Nutrition, 22*(3), Article e70222. https://doi.org/10.1111/mcn.70222

*Liu, Q., Razza, R. A., Zhang, Y., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2026). Differential growth trajectories of behavioral self-regulation from early childhood to adolescence: Implication for youth domain-general and school-specific outcomes. *Applied Developmental Science, 30*(2), 182–202. https://doi.org/10.1080/10888691.2024.2405578

Parodi, K. B., Holt, M. K., Aradhya, P., Green, J. G., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2026). A longitudinal analysis of risk and protective factors of bias-based bullying victimization among adolescents. *Journal of Interpersonal Violence, 41*(3–4), 685–709. https://doi.org/10.1177/08862605251318276

*Marsico, C., *Wyatt, O., Parodi, K. B., Holt, M. K., Green, J. G., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2026). Longitudinal associations between witnessing bias-based harassment and mental health functioning. *Journal of School Violence, 25*(1), 15–29. https://doi.org/10.1080/15388220.2025.2524335

Lawrence, T. I., Chen, L., Kwok, O., Amador, B., Palmer, L., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2026). Disentangling the bidirectional associations of depressive symptoms, impulsivity, and substance use in early adolescence: A between- and within-person perspective. *Experimental and Clinical Psychopharmacology, 34*(4), 444–452. https://doi.org/10.1037/pha0000852

Merrin, G. J., Bailey, J. A., Kelly, A. B., Le, V. T., Heerde, J. A., Doery, E., Batmaz, E. A., & Toumbourou, J. W. (2025). Continuity and change in substance use patterns during the transition from adolescence to young adulthood: Examining changes in social roles. *International Journal of Mental Health and Addiction, 23*(6), 4155–4177. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11469-024-01342-9

*Bi, K., **Merrin, G. J.**, Li, T., Sun, X., Chai, Y., Lu, Z., & Chen, M. S. (2025). Navigating unmeasured confounding in nonexperimental psychological research: A practical guide to computing and interpreting E-value. *Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science, 8*(2), Article 25152459251326571. https://doi.org/10.1177/25152459251326571

Holt, M. K., **Merrin, G. J.**, Wyatt, O., Green, J. G., Gini, G., & Fogelman, P. (2025). Direct and witnessed bias-based harassment exposures among adolescents: Associations with functioning and the influence of protective factors. *Violence and Victims, 40*(5), 701–723. https://doi.org/10.1891/VV-2023-0027

Wang, J. H., **Merrin, G. J.**, Wang, X., Liu, Q., & Kiefer, S. M. (2025). Co-occurring early adolescent ACEs and associations with later peer relationships. *Journal of Youth and Adolescence, 54*(7), 1827–1844. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10964-025-02157-0

Lawrence, T. I., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Mcfield, A. A. (2025). Family violence and adolescent aggressive behavior: The direct and indirect effects of depression and substance use. *International Journal of Mental Health and Addiction, 23*(1), 1–14. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11469-022-00971-2

*Fusco, N. V., Holt, M. K., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Green, J. G. (2025). Social-emotional functioning among bias-based bullies, victims, and bully-victims. *School Psychology, 40*(3), 397–403. https://doi.org/10.1037/spq0000620

Heerde, J. A., Bailey, J. A., **Merrin, G. J.**, Raniti, M., Patton, G. C., Toumbourou, J. W., & Sawyer, S. M. (2025). School suspension as a predictor of young adult homelessness: The International Youth Development Study. *Journal of Prevention, 46*(4), 467–485. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10935-025-00829-y

Le, V. T., Bailey, J. A., Heerde, J. A., **Merrin, G. J.**, Batmaz, E. A., Kelly, A. B., & Toumbourou, J. W. (2025). The roles of alcohol availability, overserving, and enforcement in recreational and social settings on alcohol misuse and harms: A comparison of Australia and the United States. *Journal of Studies on Alcohol and Drugs, 86*(3), 340–348. https://doi.org/10.15288/jsad.24-00036

Razza, R. A., Liu, Q., Feng, R., Hao, X., Kirkman, K. A., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2025). Cultivating adolescents' self-compassion through mindfulness: The role of self-regulation at both the individual- and classroom-level. *Contemporary School Psychology, 29*(4), 843–854. https://doi.org/10.1007/s40688-025-00548-5

*Bi, K., Chen, M. S., Zhang, C., Li, T., Liu, Y., Chen, J., Chen, H., Xie, Z., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Yip, P. S. F. (2025). Day-to-day dynamic coupling of affective symptoms in Chinese mother-adolescent and father-adolescent dyads. *Clinical Psychological Science*. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1177/21677026251369840

Merrin, G. J., Wang, J. H., Kiefer, S. M., Jackson, J. L., Pascarella, L. A., Huckaby, P. L., Blake, C. L., Gomez, M. D., & Smith, N. D. W. (2024). Adverse childhood experiences and bullying during adolescence: A systematic literature review of two decades. *Adolescent Research Review, 9*(3), 513–541. https://doi.org/10.1007/s40894-023-00229-5

Wang, J. H., **Merrin, G. J.**, Kiefer, S. M., Jackson, J. L., Huckaby, P. L., Pascarella, L. A., Blake, C. L., Gomez, M. D., & Smith, N. D. W. (2024). Peer relations of adolescents with adverse childhood experiences: A systematic literature review of two decades. *Adolescent Research Review, 9*(3), 477–512. https://doi.org/10.1007/s40894-023-00226-8

Zhang, X., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Slavich, G. M. (2024). Adverse childhood experiences (ACEs) and emotion dysregulation phenotypes: An intersectional analysis of race/ethnicity and gender in a nationally representative U.S. sample. *Child Abuse & Neglect, 158*, Article 107129. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chiabu.2024.107129

Grant, N., **Merrin, G. J.**, April, K., April-Sandars, A. K., Arora, I., & Gordon, D. (2024). A prospective study of sexual risk patterns associated with delinquency and justice involvement among child welfare system-involved male adolescents in the United States. *Perspectives on Sexual and Reproductive Health, 56*(1), 30–40. https://doi.org/10.1111/psrh.12255

*Robillard, C. L., **Merrin, G. J.**, Legg, N. K., Ames, M. E., & Turner, B. J. (2024). Different self-damaging behaviours, similar motives? Testing measurement invariance of motives for nonsuicidal self-injury, disordered eating and substance misuse. *British Journal of Clinical Psychology, 63*(3), 394–415. https://doi.org/10.1111/bjc.12467

*Liu, Q., **Merrin, G. J.**, Vasilenko, S. A., & Razza, R. A. (2024). Continuity and change in early material hardship domains on the development of children's behavioral self-regulation in middle childhood. *Children and Youth Services Review, 167*, Article 107995. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.childyouth.2024.107995

*Liu, Q., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Razza, R. A. (2024). Reciprocal associations between maternal behaviors and children's self-regulation during the transition from early to middle childhood. *Journal of Child and Family Studies, 33*(5), 1602–1617. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10826-023-02703-z

Green, J. G., Ramirez, M., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Holt, M. K. (2024). Bias-based harassment among U.S. adolescents. *School Mental Health, 16*(2), 343–353. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12310-024-09648-8

*Li, T., Wang, Z., **Merrin, G. J.**, Wan, S., Bi, K., Quintero, M., & Song, S. (2024). The joint operations of teacher-student and peer relationships on classroom engagement among low-achieving elementary students: A longitudinal multilevel study. *Contemporary Educational Psychology, 77*, Article 102258. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cedpsych.2024.102258

*Bi, K., Li, T., **Merrin, G. J.**, Zhang, C., Wang, Y., Xiao, Y., & Chen, M. S. (2024). Are there reciprocal interplays among Chinese adolescents', fathers', and mothers' depression at the within-family level? A family systems perspective. *Journal of Psychopathology and Clinical Science, 133*(2), 140–154. https://doi.org/10.1037/abn0000883

*Fairclough, J., *Abd-Elmonem, M., **Merrin, G. J.**, Hong, J. S., & Voisin, D. R. (2024). Religiosity and associations with substance use and delinquency among urban African American adolescents. *Journal of Religion and Health, 63*(1), 531–550. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10943-023-01916-2

Bailey, J. A., Le, V. T., McMorris, B. J., **Merrin, G. J.**, Heerde, J. A., Batmaz, E. A., & Toumbourou, J. W. (2024). Longitudinal associations between adult-supervised drinking during adolescence and alcohol misuse from ages 25–31 years: A comparison of Australia and the United States. *Addictive Behaviors, 153*, Article 107984. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.addbeh.2024.107984

Espelage, D. L., Kuehl, T., Wyman, P. A., Nickodem, K., Mintz, S., Valido, A., Robinson, L. E., **Merrin, G. J.**, Hoagland, K., Schmeelk-Cone, K., LoMurray, S., Woolweaver, A. B., Ingram, K. M., & Rulison, K. (2024). An RCT of Sources of Strength high school primary prevention program on sexual violence perpetration and victimization and dismissiveness of sexual harassment. *School Psychology Review, 53*(6), 649–667. https://doi.org/10.1080/2372966X.2022.2164460

*Liu, Q., Razza, R. A., Vasilenko, S. A., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2023). Associations between early material hardship and behavioral self-regulation development across childhood: A person-centered approach. *Research in Human Development, 20*(3–4), 183–207. https://doi.org/10.1080/15427609.2024.2310449

Merrin, G. J., & Low, S. (2023). Who benefits from universal SEL programming?: Assessment of Second Step© using a growth mixture modeling approach. *School Mental Health, 15*(1), 177–189. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12310-022-09542-1

*Rivas-Koehl, M. M., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Espelage, D. L. (2023). Assessing the longitudinal measurement invariance of the Conflict in Adolescent Dating Relationships Inventory (CADRI) victimization scale across heterosexual and sexual minority adolescents in the United States. *Psychology of Violence, 13*(1), 84–92. https://doi.org/10.1037/vio0000452

Leadbeater, B. J., **Merrin, G. J.**, Contreras, A., & Ames, M. E. (2023). Trajectories of oppositional defiant disorder severity from adolescence to young adulthood and substance use, mental health, and behavioral problems. *Journal of the Canadian Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry, 32*(4), 224–235. PMID: 38034412

Wang, X., Liu, Q., **Merrin, G. J.**, Keller, A., Yoon, D., & Henderson, A. (2023). Harsh parenting among veterans: parents' military-related PTSD, mentalization, and pre-military trauma. *Frontiers in Psychology, 14*, Article 1283801. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2023.1283801

Ames, M. E., Robillard, C. L., Ryan, J. E. H., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Turner, B. J. (2023). Reciprocal associations between physical activity, physical self-concept, somatic symptoms, and depression from adolescence to young adulthood: Disaggregating within- and between-person effects. *Mental Health and Physical Activity, 24*, Article 100513. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.mhpa.2023.100513

Merrin, G. J., Leadbeater, B. J., Sturgess, C. M. B., Ames, M. E., & Thompson, K. (2022). Predictors of early-onset cannabis use in adolescence and risks for substance use disorder symptoms in young adulthood. *Journal of Drug Issues, 52*(2), 182–206. https://doi.org/10.1177/00220426211049356

Valido, A., **Merrin, G. J.**, Espelage, D. L., Robinson, L. E., Nickodem, K., Ingram, K. M., El Sheikh, A. J., Torgal, C., & Fairclough, J. (2022). Social-ecological predictors of homophobic name-calling perpetration and victimization among early adolescents. *Journal of Early Adolescence, 42*(9), 1115–1151. https://doi.org/10.1177/02724316211002271

Forber-Pratt, A. J., Price, L. R., **Merrin, G. J.**, Hanebutt, R. A., & Fairclough, J. A. (2022). Psychometric properties of the Disability Identity Development Scale: Confirmatory factor and bifactor analyses. *Rehabilitation Psychology, 67*(2), 120–127. https://doi.org/10.1037/rep0000445

Leadbeater, B. J., Sukhawathanakul, P., Rush, J., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Lewis, N. (2022). Examining the effectiveness of the WITS programs in the context of variability in trajectories of child development. *Prevention Science, 23*(4), 538–551. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11121-021-01327-3

Espelage, D. L., Ingram, K. M., Hong, J. S., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2022). Bullying as a developmental precursor to sexual and dating violence across adolescence: Decade in review. *Trauma, Violence, & Abuse, 23*(4), 1358–1370. https://doi.org/10.1177/15248380211043811

Forber-Pratt, A. J., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Espelage, D. L. (2021). Exploring the intersections of disability, race and gender on student outcomes in high school. *Remedial and Special Education, 42*(5), 290–303. https://doi.org/10.1177/0741932520941201

Valido, A., Ingram, K. M., Espelage, D. L., Torgal, C., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Davis, J. P. (2021). Intra-familial violence and peer aggression among early adolescents: Moderating role of school sense of belonging. *Journal of Family Violence, 36*(1), 87–98. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10896-020-00142-8

Merrin, G. J., Davis, J. P., Ingram, K. M., & Espelage, D. L. (2020). Examining social-ecological correlates of youth gang entry among serious juvenile offenders: A survival analysis. *American Journal of Orthopsychiatry, 90*(5), 623–632. https://doi.org/10.1037/ort0000491

Merrin, G. J., Ames, M. E., Sturgess, C. M. B., & Leadbeater, B. J. (2020). Disruption of transitions in high-risk substance use from adolescence to young adulthood: School, employment, and romantic relationship factors. *Substance Use & Misuse, 55*(7), 1129–1137. https://doi.org/10.1080/10826084.2020.1729200

Forber-Pratt, A. J., **Merrin, G. J.**, Mueller, C. O., Price, L. R., & Kettrey, H. H. (2020). Initial factor exploration of disability identity. *Rehabilitation Psychology, 65*(1), 1–10. https://doi.org/10.1037/rep0000308

Davis, J. P., Ingram, K. M., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Espelage, D. L. (2020). Exposure to parental and community violence and the relationship to bullying perpetration and victimization among early adolescents: A parallel process growth mixture latent transition analysis. *Scandinavian Journal of Psychology, 61*(1), 77–89. https://doi.org/10.1111/sjop.12493

Ames, M. E., Leadbeater, B. J., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Thompson, K. (2020). Patterns of marijuana use and physical health indicators among Canadian youth. *International Journal of Psychology, 55*(1), 1–12. https://doi.org/10.1002/ijop.12549

Ingram, K. M., Espelage, D. L., Davis, J. P., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2020). Family violence, sibling, and peer aggression during adolescence: Associations with behavioral health outcomes. *Frontiers in Psychiatry, 11*, Article 26. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyt.2020.00026

Green, J. G., Holt, M. K., Oblath, R., Robinson, E., Storey, K., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2020). Engaging professional sports to reduce bullying: An evaluation of the Boston vs. Bullies program. *Journal of School Violence, 19*(3), 389–405. https://doi.org/10.1080/15388220.2019.1709849

Merrin, G. J., Davis, J. P., Berry, D., & Espelage, D. L. (2019). Developmental changes in deviant and violent behaviors from early to late adolescence: Associations with parental monitoring and peer deviance. *Psychology of Violence, 9*(2), 196–208. https://doi.org/10.1037/vio0000207

Grant, N. J., **Merrin, G. J.**, King, M. T., & Espelage, D. L. (2019). Examining within-person and between-person associations of family violence and peer deviance on bullying perpetration among middle school students. *Psychology of Violence, 9*(1), 18–27. https://doi.org/10.1037/vio0000210

Davis, J. P., **Merrin, G. J.**, Ingram, K. M., Espelage, D. L., Valido, A., & El Sheikh, A. J. (2019). Examining pathways between bully victimization, depression, & school belonging among early adolescents. *Journal of Child and Family Studies, 28*(9), 2365–2378. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10826-019-01340-9

Hatchel, T., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Espelage, D. L. (2019). Peer victimization and suicidality among LGBTQ youth: The roles of school belonging, self-compassion, and parental support. *Journal of LGBT Youth, 16*(2), 134–156. https://doi.org/10.1080/19361653.2018.1543036

Peguero, A. A., **Merrin, G. J.**, Hong, J. S., & Johnson, K. R. (2019). School disorder and dropping out: The intersection of gender, race, and ethnicity. *Youth & Society, 51*(2), 193–218. https://doi.org/10.1177/0044118X16668059

Ames, M. E., Leadbeater, B. J., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Sturgess, C. M. B. (2019). Adolescent patterns of peer victimization: Concurrent and longitudinal health correlates. *Journal of Applied Biobehavioral Research, 24*(4), Article e12151. https://doi.org/10.1111/jabr.12151

Ingram, K. M., Espelage, D. L., **Merrin, G. J.**, Valido, A., Heinhorst, J., & Joyce, M. (2019). Evaluation of a virtual reality enhanced bullying prevention curriculum pilot trial. *Journal of Adolescence, 71*(1), 72–83. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.adolescence.2018.12.006

Ingram, K. M., Davis, J. P., Espelage, D. L., Hatchel, T., **Merrin, G. J.**, Valido, A., & Torgal, C. (2019). Longitudinal associations between features of toxic masculinity and bystander willingness to intervene in bullying among middle school boys. *Journal of School Psychology, 77*, 139–151. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jsp.2019.10.007

Jones, A. E., Espelage, D. L., Valido, A., Ingram, K. M., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2019). Examining classes of bully perpetration among Latinx high school students and associations with substance use and mental health. *International Journal of Bullying Prevention, 1*(3), 170–179. https://doi.org/10.1007/s42380-019-00028-4

Thompson, K., Leadbeater, B. J., Ames, M. E., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2019). Associations between marijuana use trajectories and educational and occupational success in young adulthood. *Prevention Science, 20*(2), 257–269. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11121-018-0904-7

Merrin, G. J., Thompson, K., & Leadbeater, B. J. (2018). Transitions in the use of multiple substances from adolescence to young adulthood. *Drug and Alcohol Dependence, 189*, 147–153. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.drugalcdep.2018.05.015

Merrin, G. J., & Leadbeater, B. J. (2018). Do classes of polysubstance use in adolescence differentiate growth in substances used in the transition to young adulthood? *Substance Use & Misuse, 53*(13), 2112–2124. https://doi.org/10.1080/10826084.2018.1455702

Merrin, G. J., de la Haye, K., Espelage, D. L., Ewing, B., Tucker, J. S., Hoover, M., & Green, H. D. (2018). The co-evolution of bullying perpetration, homophobic teasing, and a school friendship network. *Journal of Youth and Adolescence, 47*(3), 601–618. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10964-017-0783-4

Merrin, G. J., Espelage, D. L., & Hong, J. S. (2018). Applying the social-ecological framework to understand the associations of bullying perpetration among high school students: A multilevel analysis. *Psychology of Violence, 8*(1), 43–56. https://doi.org/10.1037/vio0000084

Espelage, D. L., **Merrin, G. J.**, Hong, J. S., & Resko, S. M. (2018). Applying social cognitive theory to explore relational aggression across early adolescence: A within- and between-person analysis. *Journal of Youth and Adolescence, 47*(11), 2401–2413. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10964-018-0910-x

Espelage, D. L., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Hatchel, T. (2018). Peer victimization and dating violence among LGBTQ youth: The impact of school violence and crime on mental health outcomes. *Youth Violence and Juvenile Justice, 16*(2), 156–173. https://doi.org/10.1177/1541204016680408

King, M. T., **Merrin, G. J.**, Espelage, D. L., Grant, N. J., & Bub, K. L. (2018). Suicidality and intersectionality among students identifying as nonheterosexual and with a disability. *Exceptional Children, 84*(2), 141–158. https://doi.org/10.1177/0014402917736261

Thompson, K., **Merrin, G. J.**, Ames, M. E., & Leadbeater, B. J. (2018). Marijuana trajectories in Canadian youth: Associations with substance use and mental health. *Canadian Journal of Behavioural Science, 50*(1), 17–28. https://doi.org/10.1037/cbs0000090

Dumas, T. M., Davis, J. P., **Merrin, G. J.**, Puccia, M., & Blustein, D. (2018). If you're high status and you know it: Teasing apart the within- and between-person effects of peer- and self-reported status in the drinking group on alcohol-related outcomes. *Psychology of Addictive Behaviors, 32*(3), 327–337. https://doi.org/10.1037/adb0000352

Davis, J. P., Dumas, T. M., **Merrin, G. J.**, Espelage, D. L., Tan, K., Madden, D., & Hong, J. S. (2018). Examining the pathways between bully victimization, depression, academic achievement, and problematic drinking in adolescence. *Psychology of Addictive Behaviors, 32*(6), 605–616. https://doi.org/10.1037/adb0000394

Espelage, D. L., Hong, J. S., **Merrin, G. J.**, Davis, J. P., Rose, C. A., & Little, T. D. (2018). A longitudinal examination of homophobic name-calling in middle school: Bullying, traditional masculinity, and sexual harassment as predictors. *Psychology of Violence, 8*(1), 57–66. https://doi.org/10.1037/vio0000083

Leadbeater, B. J., Thompson, K., Sukhawathanakul, P., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2018). How program users enhance fidelity: Implementing the WITS programs in rural Canadian elementary schools. *Prevention Science, 19*(8), 1066–1078. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11121-018-0948-8

Davis, J. P., Dumas, T. M., Berey, B., **Merrin, G. J.**, Tan, K., & Madden, D. R. (2018). Poly-victimization and trajectories of binge drinking from adolescence to young adulthood among serious juvenile offenders. *Drug and Alcohol Dependence, 186*, 29–35. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.drugalcdep.2018.01.006

Davis, J. P., Dumas, T. M., Berey, B. L., **Merrin, G. J.**, Cimpian, J. R., & Roberts, B. W. (2017). Effect of victimization on impulse control and binge drinking among serious juvenile offenders from adolescence to young adulthood. *Journal of Youth and Adolescence, 46*(7), 1515–1532. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10964-017-0676-6

Merrin, G. J., Davis, J. P., Berry, D., D'Amico, E. J., & Dumas, T. M. (2016). The longitudinal associations between substance use, crime, and social risk among emerging adults: A longitudinal within and between-person latent variables analysis. *Drug and Alcohol Dependence, 165*, 71–78. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.drugalcdep.2016.05.009

Hong, J. S., **Merrin, G. J.**, Peguero, A. A., Gonzalez-Prendes, A. A., & Lee, N. Y. (2016). Exploring the social-ecological determinants of physical fighting in U.S. schools: What about youth in immigrant families? *Child & Youth Care Forum, 45*(2), 279–299. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10566-015-9330-1

Davis, J. P., **Merrin, G. J.**, Berry, D. J., Dumas, T. M., Hong, J. S., & Smith, D. C. (2016). Examining within-person and between-person effects of victimization and social risk on cannabis use among emerging adults in substance-use treatment. *Psychology of Addictive Behaviors, 30*(1), 52–63. https://doi.org/10.1037/adb0000121

Hong, J. S., **Merrin, G. J.**, Crosby, S., Hernandez-Jozefowicz, D. M., Lee, J. M., & Allen-Meares, P. (2016). Individual and contextual factors associated with immigrant youth feeling unsafe in school: A social-ecological analysis. *Journal of Immigrant and Minority Health, 18*(5), 996–1006. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10903-015-0242-9

Davis, J. P., Dumas, T. M., Wagner, E. F., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2016). Social ecological determinants of substance use treatment entry among serious juvenile offenders from adolescence through emerging adulthood. *Journal of Substance Abuse Treatment, 71*, 8–15. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jsat.2016.08.004

Merrin, G. J., Hong, J. S., & Espelage, D. L. (2015). Are the risk and protective factors similar for gang-involved, pressured-to-join, and non-gang-involved youth? A social-ecological analysis. *American Journal of Orthopsychiatry, 85*(6), 522–535. https://doi.org/10.1037/ort0000094

Manuscripts Under Review or Revision

Merrin, G. J., Jones, A. E., Xu, Y., Zhang, C., Hirschman, A., Katkow, E., Wang, J. H., Lawrence, T. I., Perez Ternent, A., & Zhang, Z. (under review). Co-occurring developmental pathways of bullying perpetration and victimization in childhood and adolescence: A scoping review. *Aggression and Violent Behavior*.

Merrin, G. J., Zhang, C., Jones, A. E., Bailey, J. A., Heerde, J. A., de Vries, J., Kelly, A. B., Fairclough, J., Zhang, Z., & Toumbourou, J. W. (Under Review). Conjoint substance use trajectories in adolescence and young adulthood: A scoping review. *Addiction*.

Forber-Pratt, A. J., **Merrin, G. J.**, Burdick, C. E., Ditsch, J. R. (Under Review). What shapes disability identity development? Disability visibility and duration among disabled adults. *Rehabilitation Psychology*.

Wang, J. H., Gregory, K. N., Fleming, T. C., Huckaby, P. L., **Merrin, G. J.**, Pascarella, L. A., & Munoz, N. (revised and resubmitted). "They can change the world": Principal perceptions of PCIT in Schools. *Journal of Emotional and Behavioral Disorders*.

Manuscripts in Preparation

Merrin, G. J., Jones, A. E., Jian, B., Zhang, C., Nowlan, S., Holt, M. K., Lawrence, T., & Wang, J. (in prep). The co-occurrence of bias-based perpetration, victimization, witnessing, and association with mental health and school safety. *Development and Psychopathology*.

Merrin, G. J., Jones, A. E., Zhang, C., Fairclough, J., & Holt, M. K. (in prep). Parent, peer, and school influences on adolescent bias-based harassment perpetration: Examining the mediating role of intergroup contact. *Journal of School Violence*.

Merrin, G. J., Zhang, C., de Vries, J., Bailey, J. A., Jones, A. E., Heerde, J. A., Kelly, A. B., & Fairclough, J. A. (in prep). Adolescent risk and protective factors and conjoint substance use trajectories in adolescence and young adulthood: A cross-national comparison of Washington State, U.S. and Victoria, Australia.

Merrin, G. J., Bailey, J., Jones, A. E., Zhang, C., & Fairclough, J. (in prep). Associations between adolescent poly-substance use trajectories and educational and occupational outcomes in young adulthood: A cross-national study of the US and Australia.

Merrin, G. J., Bailey, J., Jones, A. E., Zhang, C., & Fairclough, J. (in prep). Associations between adolescent poly-substance use trajectories and young adult physical and mental health trajectories: A cross-national study of the US and Australia.

Book Chapters and Encyclopedia Entries

Espelage, D. L., Hong, J. S., & **Merrin, G. J**. (2018). Relational aggression and bullying in a school context. In S. M. Coyne & J. M. Ostrov (Eds.), *The development of relational aggression* (pp. 235–247). Oxford University Press. https://doi.org/10.1093/oso/9780190491826.003.0015

Merrin, G. J. (2018). American Educational Research Association. In B. B. Frey (Ed.), *The SAGE encyclopedia of educational research, measurement, and evaluation* (Vol. 1, pp. 70–72). SAGE Publications. https://doi.org/10.4135/9781506326139.n35

Espelage, D. L., Berry, B., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Swearer, S. M. (2013). Social-ecological model in predicting workplace bullying. In L. M. Crothers & J. Lipinski (Eds.), *Bullying in the workplace: Causes, symptoms, and remedies*. Routledge.

Research Briefs, Reports, and Professional Publications

Merrin, G. J. (2026). A new tool for handling multiracial and multi-identity data in health research. *Lerner Center Population Health Research Brief Series*. Research Brief #141. https://doi.org/10.14305/rt.lerner.2026.3

Leadbeater, B., Thompson, K., Ames, M., **Merrin, G. J.**, Sukhawathanakul, P., & Sturgess, S. (2017). Using cannabis in the transition to young adulthood: Recognizing and reducing risks. *Psynopsis, 39*(4), 10–11. https://cpa.ca/docs/File/Psynopsis/2017/PsynopsisFall2017.pdf

Espelage, D. L., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2014). Adjustment of students who experience school bullying: Empirical examination of the social-ecological theory. Prepared for: Korea-US Joint Research on the Support of School Bullying Prevention and Intervention: The Relations between School Bullying and School Adjustment.

Statistical Software

Nickodem, K., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2025). *CATAcode: Explore and Code Responses to Check-All-that-Apply Survey Items*. R package version 1.0.0. https://doi.org/10.32614/CRAN.package.CATAcode

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks and Keynotes

Merrin, G. J. (2023, August). Navigating the complexities of measuring and modeling polysubstance use from adolescence to young adulthood. Presentation given at Science Wednesdays, University of Washington, Department of Social Work.

Merrin, G. J. (2022, April). High stakes but weak effects: New challenges for school-based prevention. Keynote address at Illinois Wesleyan University John Wesley Powell Student Research Conference, Bloomington, IL.

Merrin, G. J., Hong, J. S., & Espelage, D. L. (2019, November). *Are the risk and protective factors similar for gang-involved, pressured-to-join, and non-gang-involved youth? A social-ecological analysis*. Paper presented at the Voice of Our Youth, Dane County Youth Authority Research Summit, Madison, WI.

Forber-Pratt, A., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Espelage, D. L. (2019, November). *Exploring the intersections of disability, race & gender on peer victimization, suicidal ideation, and school connectedness in*

high school. Paper presented at the Voice of Our Youth, Dane County Youth Authority Research Summit, Madison, WI.

Conference Presentations

Selected conference presentations from 2023-2026 (90+ total presentations).

Merrin, G. J., Jones, A. E., Xu, Y., Zhang, C., Hirschman, A., Katkow, E., Wang, J., Lawrence, T., Perez Ternent, A., & Zhang, Z. (2027, April 14-18). Co-occurring developmental pathways of bullying perpetration and victimization in childhood and adolescence: A scoping review [Paper presentation – UNDER REVIEW]. American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Toronto, ON, Canada.

Wang, J. H., **Merrin, G. J.**, Cocar Montenegro, F. P., & Kiefer, S. M. (February 2027). Unlocking adolescent academic motivation: Evidence from a decade of Research. Paper submitted to the 2027 annual convention of the National Association of School Psychologists (NASP). Charlotte, NC.

Merrin, G. J., Jones, A. E., Jian, B., Zhang, C., Nowlan, S., & Holt, M. K. (2026, April 8–12). Bias-based bullying and adolescent well-being: A person-centered analysis of co-occurring trajectories [Paper presentation]. American Educational Research Association Annual Conference, Los Angeles, CA, United States.

Merrin, G. J., Wang, J. H., Lawrence, T., Liu, Q., Wang, X., & Kiefer, S. M. (2026, February 24–27). ACEs and peer pathways to school dropout: A longitudinal analysis [Paper presentation]. National Association of School Psychologists Annual Convention, Chicago, IL, United States.

Wang, J. H., **Merrin, G. J.**, Liu, Q., Lawrence, T., Wang, X., & Kiefer, S. M. (2026, February 24–27). Adolescent reading underachievement: Ecological analyses of ACEs and peer pathways [Paper presentation]. National Association of School Psychologists Annual Convention, Chicago, IL, United States.

Holt, M. K., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Preda, A. M. (2026, November 7–12). *Trajectories of mental health symptoms among transgender and nonbinary adolescents: Protective role of gender minority communities and social support* [Poster presentation]. World Professional Association for Transgender Health Annual Symposium, Mexico City, Mexico.

Green, J. G., Holt, M. K., **Merrin, G. J.**, Parodi, K. B., & Fusco, N. (2026, August 6–8). *Current research on bias-based bullying and harassment* [Paper presentation]. American Psychological Association Annual Convention, Washington, DC, United States.

Merrin, G. J., Wang, J. H., Wang, X., Liu, Q., & Kiefer, S. M. (2025, June). Early adolescent ACEs and associations with bullying perpetration and victimization, and peer relationship outcomes during late adolescence. Paper presented at the 2025 World Anti-Bullying Forum, Stavanger, Norway.

*Huang, Y., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Medina, M. (2025, April). Typologies and correlates of perceived academic stress among Chinese adolescents: a latent class analysis. Paper presented at the 2025 American Education Research Association Annual Convention, Denver, CO, United States.

Holt, M. K., Green, J. G., **Merrin, G. J.**, Wyatt, O., and Reeves, D. (2025, April). *An Evaluation of Boston vs. Bullies: Effectiveness of Changing Bullying Knowledge, Attitudes and Behaviors*. Poster presented at the American Educational Research Association Annual Convention, Denver, CO.

Holt, M. K., Parodi, K. B., Fusco, N. V., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Hamer, E. (2025, April). *Longitudinal associations between multiple forms of bias-based bullying victimization and adolescent functioning*. Poster presented at the American Educational Research Association Conference, Denver, CO.

Parodi, K., Fusco, N., Holt, M. K., Hamer, E., **Merrin, G. J.** (2025, April). Longitudinal associations between multiple forms of bias-based bullying victimization and adolescent functioning. Paper presented at the 2025 American Education Research Association Annual Convention, Denver, CO, United States.

Wang, J. H., **Merrin, G. J.**, Wang, X., Liu, Q., & Kiefer, S. M. (2025, February 21). *An overlooked area in trauma-informed care for adolescents: Peer relations.* Paper presented at the National Association of School Psychologists Annual Convention, Seattle, WA, United States.

Shafi, S., Mulvaney, M., **Merrin, G. J.** (2025, February). Examining the structure and correlates of contemporary Islamophobia. Poster presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology 2025 annual convention.

Merrin, G. J., Jian, B., Holt, M. K., Green, J. G., & Liu, Q. (2024, November). Co-occurring patterns of bias-based harassment among adolescents: Differential associations with mental health and perceptions of school safety and support. Poster presented at the National Council on Family Relations Annual Conference. Bellevue, WA.

*Liu, Q., Razza, R., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2024, November). Continuity and change in material hardship domains and their long-term associations with children's behavioral self-regulation: A multidimensional growth mixture model. Paper presented at the National Council on Family Relations Annual Conference. Bellevue, WA.

*Ramirez, M. A., Green, J. G., Holt, M., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2024, February). Experiences with bias-based harassment among U.S. adolescents with disabilities. Poster presented at the National Association of School Psychologists Annual Conference. New Orleans, LA.

Wang, X., Zhang, X., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2024, January). The Heterogeneity of Developmental Profiles of Adolescents Experiencing Substantial Adverse Childhood Experiences. Poster presented at the Society for Social Work and Research 28th Annual Virtual Conference. Washington D.C.

Merrin, G. J., Wang, J. H., & Blake, C. L. (2023, October). Bullying perpetration and victimization among adolescents with adverse childhood experience: A systematic review. Paper symposium presented at the 2023 World Anti-Bullying Forum, Raleigh, NC.

Holt, M. K., **Merrin, G. J.**, Wyatt, O., & Green, J. G. (2023, October). Patterns of bias-based harassment exposure over time among adolescents: Differential associations with functioning. Paper symposium presented at the 2023 World Anti-Bullying Forum, Raleigh, NC.

*Wyatt, O., Holt, M. K., **Merrin, G. J.**, Green, J. G., & Curtis, N. (2023, October). Differences in teacher and student perspectives on prevalence and response to bias-based bullying in middle and high schools. Paper symposium presented at the 2023 World Anti-Bullying Forum, Raleigh, NC.

Merrin, G. J., Sunita, I. A., Grant, N., April-Sanders, A., & Gordon, D. (2023, September). Using longitudinal growth mixture models and latent class analysis to investigate how DV exposure impacts mental health outcomes and substance use in U.S. child-welfare involved adolescents. In *Calling Systems to Account: Challenging Domestic Violence Conceptualization and Approaches in Varied Contexts*. Paper symposium presented at the 2023 European Conference on Domestic Violence, Reykjavik, Iceland.

Sunita, I. A., Murphy, C., Nnawulezi, N. Shivakumar, A. K., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Gordon, D. (2023, September). Multi-level Risk and Protective Factors of Husband's Domestic Violence against Child Brides in Bihar, India. In *Calling Systems to Account: Challenging Domestic Violence Conceptualization and Approaches in Varied Contexts*. Paper symposium presented at the 2023 European Conference on Domestic Violence, Reykjavik, Iceland.

Merrin, G. J., Bailey, J., Kelly, A., Le, V., & Toumbourou, J. (2023, June). Continuity and change in patterns of substance use in the transition from adolescence to young adulthood: Examining timing of adult role assumptions. In *Understanding persistence and desistence of substance use in young adulthood: Developmental transitions, policy environments, and marginalized populations*. Paper Symposium presented at the Society for Prevention Research 2023 Conference.

Merrin, G. J. (2023, March). Invited discussant for *Adverse Experiences at School: Bias-based Bullying by Peers and Unfair Treatment by Teachers* panel. Presented at the Society for Research in Child Development 2023 Biennial Conference.

Holt, M., **Merrin, G. J.**, Fusco, N., & Green, J. (2023, March). Bias-Based Harassment among Adolescents: Differential Associations with Functioning Based on Involvement Type. In Holt, M. (Chair), *Adverse Experiences at School: Bias-based Bullying by Peers and Unfair Treatment by Teachers*. Paper symposium presented at the Society for Research in Child Development 2023 Biennial Conference.

Holt, M., Zimski, P., **Merrin, G.J.**, Liu, Q., Green, J.G., & Gini, G. (2023, August). Bias-based harassment and its associations with depression, anxiety, and substance use among adolescents: Identifying protective factors. In M. Holt & O. Wyatt (Chairs), *Bias-based Bullying among Adolescents: Protective Factors and Bystander Interventions*. Paper symposium presented at the American Educational Research Association's Annual Meeting.

*Liu, Q.Y., Razza, R.A., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Zhang, Y. (2023, March). Differential Growth Trajectories of Self-Regulation from Early Childhood to Adolescence: Implications for Adolescent Behavioral Outcomes. In Liu, Q.Y., & Razza, R.A. (Co-chair), *Leveraging Latent Growth Modeling to Understand Antecedents and Consequences of Self-Regulation from Early Childhood to Adolescence*. Paper symposium presented at the Society for Research in Child Development 2023 Biennial Conference.

Wang, X.F., Liu, Q.Y., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2023, March). Veteran Parents' Posttraumatic Stress Disorder and Harsh Parenting: Parental Pre-Mentalization as a Mediator. In Zhang, Y. & Wang, X.F. (Co-chair), *Informing Prevention and Intervention Programs Targeting Adverse Childhood Experiences (ACEs)*. Paper symposium presented at the Society for Research in Child Development 2023 Biennial Conference.

*Xu, Y., Liu, Q.Y., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Razza, R.A. (2023, March). Linking Early Fathering Trajectories to Child Social Behavioral Profiles in Middle Childhood: A Latent Transition Study. In Liu, Q.Y., & Ren, H. G. (Co-chair), *Leveraging Innovative Person-Centered Approaches to Study the Antecedents and Consequences of Parenting and Child Behaviors*. Paper Symposium presented at the Society for Research in Child Development 2023 Biennial Conference.

Ames, M. E., Robillard, C. L., Ryan, J. E. H., **Merrin, G. J.**, & Turner, B. J. (2023, March). *Reciprocal associations between physical activity, self-concept, somatic symptoms, and depression from adolescence to young adulthood: Disaggregating within- and between-person effects*. Poster presented at the 2023 annual convention of the Society for Research on Adolescence (SRA). San Diego, CA.

HONORS AND AWARDS

2026–2030	Zeta Psi Endowed Faculty Fellow, Syracuse University (2026–2030)
2025–2027	Merrin, G. J. (Awardee). The development of poly-substance use in two countries: Examining early risk and resilience and young adult outcomes — National Institutes of Health, Loan Repayment Program Award (2025 - 2027).

2025–2026	Syracuse University 2025 - 2026 SOURCE Research Assistant Grant
2024	Syracuse University 2024 Falk College Faculty of the Year Award for Excellence in Research
2024	Syracuse University 2024 Excellence in Graduate Education Faculty Recognition Award
2021–2022	Texas Tech University 2021-2022 Alumni Association New Faculty Award
2016–2017	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, College of Education, 2016-2017 Outstanding Student Medal Award for Doctoral Students (Graduation Speech)
2015–2016	University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, College of Education, 2015-2016 Outstanding Teaching Award for Teaching Assistants
2015	University of Illinois, College of Education, 2015 Conference Best Paper Award. Paper entitled: Developmental Changes in Delinquency from Early to Late Adolescence: Associations with Parental Monitoring and Peer Deviance
2012–2017	University of Illinois Teachers Ranked as Excellent (Fall 2012, Fall 2013, Spring 2013, Fall 2014, Spring 2014, Spring 2015, Spring 2017)
2013	University of Illinois, College of Education 2013 Conference Best Paper Award. Paper entitled: "First person I see, I'm bout to get to ridin' on." Exploring the Effects of Roasting Among Middle School Students

TEACHING

Syracuse University September 2021 – Present

Assistant Professor (2021–2026) and Associate Professor (2026–Present), Department of Human Development and Family Science

HFS 202: Development of Children
HFS 300: Youth Gangs and Adolescent Development
HFS 395: Risk, Resilience, and Intervention
HFS 474: Promises and Problems in Youth and Emerging Adulthood
HFS 653: Developmental Research Methods
HFS 800: Applied Structural Equation Modeling

Texas Tech University August 2019 – 2021

Assistant Professor, Department of Human Development and Family Sciences

HDFS 6365: Quantitative Methods III – Foundations of Structural Equation Modeling
HDFS 6370: Quantitative Methods IV – Longitudinal Structural Equation Modeling
HDFS 6363: Risk-Taking and Adolescent Health

University of Victoria September 2017 – January 2018

Instructor, Department of Psychology

PSYC 345A: Drugs and Behavior: Basic Principles

University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign August 2012 – May 2017

Teaching Assistant, Department of Educational Psychology

EPSY 202: Exploring Cultural Diversity
EPSY 580: Statistical Inference in Education
EPSY 573: Methods of Educational Inquiry

MENTORING: THESIS AND DISSERTATION COMMITTEES (COMPLETED)

Doctoral Dissertation Committees

3/2025 **Linghua Jiang**, Human Development and Family Sciences, Syracuse University. Advisor: Sara Vasilenko.

3/2025 **Qingyang Liu**, Human Development and Family Sciences, Syracuse University. Advisor: Rachel Razza.

10/2023 **Javari Fairclough**, Human Development and Family Sciences, Texas Tech University. Advisor: Monica Martin.

8/2023 **Sanum Shafi**, Human Development and Family Science, Syracuse University. Advisor: Matthew Mulvaney.

8/2022 **Xiaoyan Zhang**, Human Development and Family Science, Syracuse University. Advisor: Merril Silverstein.

4/2022 **Tianyu Li**, Human Development and Family Science, Texas Tech University. Advisor: Zhe Wang.

5/2021 **Omolola A. Odejimi**, Educational Psychology, Texas Tech University. Advisor: Todd Little.

Master's Thesis Committees

8/2023 **Suzanne Holland**, Human Development and Family Science, Syracuse University. Advisor: Rachel Razza.

5/2023 **Dominica Colavito**, Human Development and Family Science, Syracuse University. Advisor: Kamala Ramadoss.

4/2023 **Chloe Ludden**, Human Development and Family Science, Syracuse University. Advisor: Sara Vasilenko.

6/2022 **Sara Alansaari**, Human Development and Family Science, Syracuse University. Advisor: Sara Vasilenko.

5/2022 **Shuangyue Cui**, Human Development and Family Science, Syracuse University. Advisor: Eunjoo Jung.

4/2022 **Abby Picinich**, Human Development and Family Science, Syracuse University. Advisor: Sara Vasilenko.

4/2022 **McKeena Farley**, Human Development and Family Science, Syracuse University. Advisor: Sara Vasilenko.

4/2021 **Bethany Phelps**, Human Development and Family Sciences, Texas Tech University. Advisor: Malinda Colwell.

SERVICE TO THE PROFESSION

Editorial Board Membership

2020–2022 *Prevention Science*

2020–2022 *Psychology of Violence*

Leadership in Professional Organizations

2019–2020 Code of Conduct Policy Task Force — Society for Prevention Research (SPR)

2016–2018	Social Justice and Action Committee: Student Representative — American Educational Research Association (AERA)
2016–2017	Graduate Student Council: Past Chair — American Educational Research Association (AERA)
2015–2016	Council: Student Representative — American Educational Research Association (AERA)
2015–2016	Graduate Student Council: Chair — American Educational Research Association (AERA)
2014–2015	Graduate Student Council: Chair-Elect — American Educational Research Association (AERA)
2013–2014	Division E: Webmaster — American Educational Research Association (AERA)

Ad Hoc Reviewer

90+ verified peer reviews completed; Web of Science.

Addiction · American Journal of Criminal Justice · American Journal of Epidemiology · American Journal of Preventive Medicine · Applied Developmental Psychology · Child and Youth Care Forum · Drug and Alcohol Dependence · Exceptional Children · International Journal of Mental Health and Addiction · JAMA Network Open · Journal of Affective Disorders · Journal of Child and Adolescent Substance Abuse · Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry · Journal of Drug Issues · Journal of Family Violence · Journal of Interpersonal Violence · Journal of Orthopsychiatry · Journal of Prevention and Health Promotion · Journal of Quantitative Criminology · Journal of Social Issues · PLOS ONE · Prevention Science · Psychology of Violence · Research on Child and Adolescent Psychopathology · Rural Sociology · Sexual Abuse · Substance Use and Misuse · Victims and Offenders · Violence and Gender

Statistical Consulting and Program Evaluation

2023–2024	The Sports Museum (Boston, MA) – Evaluation of Boston vs. Bullies.
2021–2024	Anti-Defamation League (Washington, D.C.) – Evaluation of No Place for Hate.
2018–2020	Committee for Children (Seattle, Washington) – Evaluation of Second Step Program.
2017–2019	Vancouver Island Health Authority (British Columbia, Canada) – Evaluation of health service utilization for patients with substance use and mental health issues.
2018–2019	Christopher and Dana Reeve Foundation (Short Hills, New Jersey) – Evaluation of disability programming.

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Syracuse University

2026	Chair of the Faculty Norms Sub-Committee (Spring 2026 – Fall 2026)
2023–Present	Graduate Committee (Fall 2025 – Present; Fall 2023 – Spring 2024)
2025	Faculty advisor for the HDFS Future Professoriate Program (Spring 2025)
2024–2025	HDFS Assessment Committee (Fall 2024 – Spring 2025)
2023–Present	Faculty advisor for Mixtape, an Undergraduate Student Group (Fall 2023 – Present)
2023–2024	Faculty advisor for HDFS Graduate Student Group (Fall 2023 – Fall 2024)
2023–2026	Graduate Application Committee (Fall 2025 – Spring 2026, Fall 2023 – Spring 2024)
2021–2023	Undergraduate Committee (Fall 2021 – Spring 2023)

2022	Shaw Center Hiring Committee (Fall 2022)
2022	HDFS Award Committee (Spring 2022)
2023	HDFS Chair of Colloquium Committee (Spring 2023)

Texas Tech University

2021	Graduate Student Award Committee (Fall 2021)
2020–2021	Methods Qualifying Exam Committee
2019–2020	Interview Committee for the Human Development and Family Studies Ambassadors

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2013–2014	College of Education Diversity Committee, Student representative
2013–2014	Department of Educational Psychology Child Development Search Committee, Student representative
2012–2013	Department of Educational Psychology Executive Committee, Student representative

OUTREACH AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

2024–Present	**Elmcrest Children's Center Board of Directors, Syracuse, NY** (Fall 2024 – Present)
2019–2021	**Texas Tech University Community Advocacy Project for Students**, Student Advocate
2015–2017	**Champaign County Juvenile Detention Center**, Adolescent Advocacy
2015–2017	**UP Center of Champaign County**, Board Member
2015–2017	**Danville, Illinois Public Schools**, Building a Restorative Justice System within a local High School

MEDIA COVERAGE

Davis, J. P., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2016, October 6). Delinquent youths with PTSD need individualized treatment, studies suggest. Interviewer Sharita Forrest with the Illinois News Bureau. Retrieved from https://education.illinois.edu/about/news-events/news/article/2016/10/03/delinquent-youth-with-ptsd-need-individualized-treatment-study-suggest

Davis, J. P., & **Merrin, G. J.** (2016, December 1). Adolescents with PTSD history more likely to struggle with substance abuse. Interviewer Jess Peterson with the Daily Illini. Retrieved from http://dailyillini.com/special-sections/2016/12/01/adolescents-ptsd-history-likely-struggle-substance-abuse/

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PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

American Education Research Association (AERA)
Association for Psychological Science (APS)
Society for Prevention Research (SPR)

Society for Research on Adolescence (SRA)
Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD)